



Feasibility Overview

2 Gyfford Walk, Cheshunt, Hertfordshire, EN7 5BT | TH00209 | Prepared for Daniel Grant,
Grant Homes Ltd

1. Property and Location Overview

The subject property is a two storey semi detached house on Gyfford Walk, a residential cul de sac off Turners Hill in Cheshunt. It currently provides a two bedroom dwelling in Use Class C3.

The property benefits from a substantial single storey rear extension already completed under permitted development, a dedicated ground floor utility room, a large rear garden, and side access down the flank. The side access is valuable for the fire escape strategy where a rear bedroom is served through the kitchen.

The location is a settled suburban area. It is not in a conservation area, is not listed, is not in the Green Belt, and lies within Flood Zone 1. Local amenities are a short distance away, and Cheshunt is served by bus routes on Turners Hill and by London Overground rail services into central London. The client already operates an HMO nearby at Oldfield Drive, which confirms the area supports the model.

HMO concentration in the surrounding area is low. Broxbourne has no HMO density or sandwich policy, and few HMOs are present locally.

2. Proposed HMO Strategy

Target use: A six bedroom, all en suite house in multiple occupation for six people in Use Class C4, delivered by internal reconfiguration and a loft conversion, with no ground floor extension.

This strategy:

- Keeps the scheme within Use Class C4, so the change of use is permitted development and needs no planning permission.
- Avoids sui generis, which would apply at seven or more bedrooms and would require full planning permission and a parking survey.
- Uses the existing rear extension and footprint, so no ground floor extension cost is incurred.
- Relocates the boiler and services to the ground floor utility room, freeing the loft for bedrooms.

Bedroom and amenity approach

- Every bedroom is en suite. En suite provision supports commercial lending value and tenant demand.
- Each room is designed to take a wet station with a sink, a fridge and cupboards, matching the client's existing product.
- The client priority is generous bedrooms ahead of a large communal room. The scheme holds the communal kitchen and dining space at a functional 17 square metres and directs remaining floor area into the bedrooms. This is acceptable on the certificate of lawful development route and is consistent with six bedroom schemes approved locally.

Two options are presented, reflecting the loft uncertainty set out in Section 3.



3. Design Opportunities and Key Constraints

Ground floor

- Retain the utility room at 4.5 square metres and the boiler room at 1.5 square metres, positioned away from the bedrooms where appliance noise is less intrusive.
- Bedroom 1 at 14 square metres with an en suite.
- Bedroom 2 at 12 square metres with an en suite.
- A combined kitchen and dining room at 17 square metres, with direct access to the rear garden

First floor

- Bedroom 3 at 12 square metres with an en suite, formed by rotating the existing door.
- Bedroom 4 at 11 square metres with an en suite, achieved by removing the chimney breast to maximise the room.
- The existing staircase and an existing WC are retained to keep build cost down.

Loft, the key variable

- The loft is the make or break of the six bedroom scheme. Ceiling height and available headroom have not yet been measured.
- Only floor area with a ceiling height above 1.5 metres counts toward the room size for planning and licensing. Where the first floor has sufficient height, the loft floor can be dropped to gain headroom, subject to survey.
- Option A, six bedrooms. If the loft headroom is sufficient, two loft bedrooms are achieved: Bedroom 5 at 12.3 square metres and Bedroom 6 at 9.7 square metres, both en suite. (Subject to survey)
- Option B, five bedrooms. If the loft is too tight for two rooms, a single large loft bedroom of 22 square metres with an en suite is provided. (Subject to survey)

External and servicing

- The only external building work is at roof level: a hip to gable loft conversion and a full width rear dormer. The front roof slope is unaltered.
- Refuse storage requires a screened bin store of at least 2.5 by 1.0 metres within the front or side curtilage, shown on the drawings, in line with the Waste Supplementary Planning Guidance.
- Cycle storage can be accommodated in the rear garden or side access.

4. Planning Position and Risk

Principle of development

- The change of use to a six person C4 HMO is permitted development. Broxbourne has no Article 4 direction. This is confirmed by recent certificates of lawful development granted in Cheshunt, including 42 Bury Green Road and 92 Great Cambridge Road.
- A directly comparable scheme at 11 Grenville Close, Cheshunt, a semi detached house converted to a seven bedroom all en suite HMO with a rear dormer, has been approved. This places the proposed six bedroom scheme comfortably within local precedent.

Key planning risk

The single planning risk is the roof. The combined hip to gable and full width rear dormer on a semi may exceed the 50 cubic metre permitted development allowance for roof enlargements, which is a single cumulative cap. If exceeded, the roof works require a householder planning



application rather than proceeding under permitted development. Local dormer refusals, at 4 The Drive in Hoddesdon and 3 Cheshunt Folly, turned on bulk and prominence. A dormer set down from the ridge, set back from the eaves and finished in matching materials mitigates this risk.

Secondary points

- Parking is not a constraint for the certificate of lawful development route, which does not assess parking. The street accommodates on street parking. A parking survey would only be relevant if the scheme moved to seven or more bedrooms.
- The site carries no heritage, Green Belt or flood constraint.

Recommended route

- Proceed by a certificate of lawful development for the change of use, supported by existing and proposed drawings.
- If the survey confirms the roof works exceed permitted development, either submit a householder planning application for the dormer, or design the dormer to remain within the 50 cubic metre allowance and secure a certificate of lawful development for the roof works.

5. Building Regulations and Technical Compliance

The conversion is a full technical upgrade, not a light refurbishment. The following apply.

Part B, fire

- A protected escape route, mains linked fire detection, fire doors and appropriate compartmentation. The side access supports the escape strategy for the rear ground floor bedroom.

Part E, acoustics

- Upgraded floor and party wall performance between bedrooms and to the communal areas.

Part L, thermal

- Insulation and services upgrades, with a minimum EPC rating of E required for letting.

Part F, ventilation

- Mechanical extract to all en suites, bathrooms and the kitchen.

The loft conversion additionally engages structural design for the new floor and dormer, and a Building Regulations head height on the new stair.

6. Commercial Position

Comparable en suite room rents in Cheshunt (EN7 and EN8), bills included, currently sit between 750 and 850 pounds per month on SpareRoom, with en suite rooms clustering around 800 pounds. A mid market figure of 800 pounds per room per month is adopted.

Option A, six bedrooms

- Gross monthly rent: 4,800 pounds.
- Gross annual rent: 57,600 pounds.
- Net annual rent at a 25 percent operating cost allowance: 43,200 pounds.
- Indicative gross development value at an 8.5 percent commercial yield: approximately 508,000 pounds.



Option B, five bedrooms

- Gross monthly rent: 4,000 pounds.
- Gross annual rent: 48,000 pounds.
- Net annual rent: 36,000 pounds.
- Indicative gross development value at an 8.5 percent yield: approximately 424,000 pounds.

A build cost benchmark of 25,000 to 35,000 pounds per bedroom applies for a full fire, acoustic, thermal and ventilation upgrade, giving approximately 180,000 pounds for six bedrooms and 150,000 pounds for five, before contingency. The existing rear extension removes a ground floor extension cost, which improves the position, particularly for the five bedroom fallback.

All figures are indicative and subject to validation. The client's own nearby scheme at Waltham Cross, a six bedroom all en suite HMO, was valued at 790,000 pounds on refinance, which indicates the local market can support a keener yield or higher achieved rents than the conservative assumptions used here.

Comparable evidence

- En suite double, Cheshunt EN7, 800 pounds per month, bills included.
- En suite double, Cheshunt EN8, 750 to 850 pounds per month, bills included.
- Double room, Cheshunt EN7, 825 to 850 pounds per month, bills included.
- Source: SpareRoom, Cheshunt, en suite filter, accessed July 2026.

7. Key Next Steps

- Carry out a measured survey of the loft as the priority, confirming ridge height, available headroom, and whether the loft floor can be dropped. This determines Option A or Option B.
- Confirm the combined roof volume against the 50 cubic metre permitted development allowance once the survey is available.
- Prepare existing and proposed drawings and submit a certificate of lawful development for the change of use.
- Confirm the commercial mortgage position for a five bedroom fallback with a broker, as lenders typically prefer six bedrooms.
- After the Lawful Development Certificate has been approved, we can prepare a full technical package for Building Control and your builder. This will include the detailed construction drawings and all the information required to build the project.

8. Conclusion

2 Gyfford Walk is a sound feasibility candidate. The change of use to a six bedroom C4 HMO is permitted development, the site carries no heritage, Green Belt or flood constraint, and local precedent, including a larger approved scheme at 11 Grenville Close, strongly supports the principle.

The scheme delivers four bedrooms across the ground and first floors without difficulty. The sixth bedroom, and therefore the difference between Option A and Option B, depends entirely on the loft. The loft must be measured before the acquisition is confirmed.

Six bedrooms is the recommended target, at an indicative gross development value of approximately 508,000 pounds and an indicative build cost of approximately 180,000 pounds,



subject to the loft survey. The five bedroom layout provides a defensible fallback, assisted by the fact that the rear extension is already built. The scheme is held at six bedrooms rather than pushed higher, since seven or more would become sui generis, require full planning permission, and introduce parking and amenity scrutiny that the current permitted development route avoids.